



Learning Space

IAS MAINS 2020

ETHICS, INTEGRITY & APTITUDE

CASE STUDIES

MODULE - 12

CASE STUDY - 12

Influenced by the work of one of your uncles, a civil services officer, you set out on a journey to become a civil servant to fulfill your ambition of making a positive contribution to the society. After years of diligence and toil, and a few failures in clearing even the prelims examination, you are finally able to clear the UPSC CSE mains and are elated to receive a call for the interview. Driving on your way to attend the interview with great anticipation, you witness a road accident. A mother and her child are in a critical state after the two wheeler the mother was driving rammed into the road divider. The people at the scene are either apathetic or busy making videos of the ghastly scene to share on the social media, making no attempt to come to the rescue of the accident victims. Any more delay in providing the medical aid to them may prove fatal as the 'golden hour' is fast running out.

What choices do you have at that instant? Explain. How would you act if it were your last attempt for UPSC CSE? (250 words)

CASE STUDIES

The case touches the sensitivities of human emotions when certain uncertain yet profound incidents are encountered in life.

ETHICAL ISSUES INVOLVED

Protecting life of accident victims
(humanity)

VS

Attending UPSC interview
(hardship and selfishness)

As a serious aspirant of UPSC CSE, I have the following options:

1. TAKE THEM TO HOSPITAL

MERITS

- Saving lives
- Upheld humanity

DEMERITS

- Might miss interview
- Hard work is in vain

2. IGNORE THEM AND ATTEND INTERVIEW

MERITS

- Interview and join service
- Higher social status

DEMERITS

- Unethical and immoral
- Upheld selfishness

DECISION I WILL CHOOSE

- Call an ambulance, take help from social media or friends near by to immediately shift the victims to hospital.
- In case of no response from anyone, take them to hospital myself.
- Immediately inform UPSC about what happened with relevant proof.
- UPSC has a provision to accept the delay and postpone the interview incase of emergencies and if certain conditions are satisfied.
- If UPSC accepts: win-win situation
- If UPSC does not accept:
 - ✓ Even then take them to hospital.
- One need not be a civil service officer to serve and make a contribution to the society as witnessed in the phenomenal work of Mahatma Gandhi, Mother Teresa and Kailash Satyarthi, among others.
 - ✓ But, life once lost cannot be brought back.

CONCLUSION

Human relations are based on reciprocal nature: If I expect others to help me, then I should also help others. Tomorrow, If I face similar situation, I expect other persons to reciprocate my action.

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SINCERE THANKS
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